

## Nicholas Forster-Benson

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<https://nfb77.github.io/>

### Education

- 2025 -            Ph.D. Sociology & Social Policy, Harvard University, Cambridge, Massachusetts
- 2021 - 2025     B.A. Economics; Quantitative Social Science, Vanderbilt University, Nashville, Tennessee  
                      *magna cum laude*, highest honors (economics)  
                      visiting student (graduate coursework), Università Bocconi, Milano, Lombardia

### Research Interests

|                        |                                       |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Political economy      | Organizational and economic sociology |
| Markets and inequality | Quantitative methods                  |

### Publications

- 2025            **N. Forster-Benson** and K. Nchare. "[Upzoning and Residential Transaction Price in Nashville](#)." *Journal of Housing Economics*, 70: 102104.

### Works in Progress

- N. Forster-Benson**. "[Corporate Ownership Density and Rent in the United States: An Analysis from 2012-2022](#)." Working paper.
- N. Forster-Benson**. "Upzoning, Density, and the Financialization of Space in Nashville." Under Review.
- N. Forster-Benson**. "Towards a Relational Understanding of Zoning Conflict." In Preparation.
- N. Forster-Benson** and K. Nchare. "[Trade Distortions and Colonial Legacy: Evidence from Portugal and Its Former Colonies](#)." Revise & Resubmit, *Journal of International Development*.

### Public Writing

- 2026            **N. Forster-Benson**. "Rethinking the Housing Crisis: What Abundance Can't Fix." Forthcoming in *Jacobin*.

## Grants and Fellowships

### *External:*

2026      Housing Case Studies Grant, Social Science Research Council (SSRC), Better Urbanism, Infrastructure, and Land-Use Decisions (BUILD) Program, with Karim Nchare, \$10,000

### *Internal:*

2026      Graduate Seed Grant, Center for American Political Studies at Harvard University \$1,000  
2024      John J. Siegfried Honors Economics Scholars Student Research Grant, \$2,000  
2023      Humanities in the Real-World Fellow, Robert Penn Warren Center, \$1,000  
2023      Vanderbilt Undergraduate Summer Research Program, \$7,100

## Teaching

### *Department of Economics, Vanderbilt University:*

Fall 2024      Economic Statistics (ECON 1500), Teaching Assistant, [Syllabus](#)

### *Department of Sociology, Vanderbilt University:*

Fall 2022, 2023      Contemporary American Society (SOC 3233), Teaching Assistant, [Syllabus](#)  
Fall 2023      Cultural Production and Institutions (SOC 3202), Teaching Assistant, [Syllabus](#)

## Research

2023 - 2025      Research Assistant, Department of Economics, Vanderbilt University  
*Advisor: Dr. Karim Nchare*  
2023      Research Assistant, Department of Sociology, Vanderbilt University  
*Advisor: Dr. Richard Lloyd*  
2023      Research Assistant, Lab. for Research on Conflict and Collective Action  
*Advisor: Dr. Andrew Coe*

## Non-Academic Employment

2026 -      Graduate Resident Advisor, Harvard Graduate School of Arts and Sciences  
2022 - 2025      Resident Advisor, V. U. Office of Housing and Residential Experience  
2024      Candidate, Tennessee State House District 56  
2023      Intern, U.S. Federal Reserve Board  
2022      Intern, Tennessee Department of Treasury

## Affiliation

2025 -      Graduate affiliate, Center for American Political Studies, Harvard University  
2025 -      Graduate affiliate, Institute for Quantitative Social Science, Harvard University  
2025 -      Member, American Sociological Association  
2023 -      Member, American Planning Association

## Programming Languages

L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X, Python, QGIS, R, Stata